GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

December 19th, 2025
Week 51
Volume 279, Issue 1216

Highlights:

- **Landmark year.**
- **Upgrades continue.**
- **Reduced supply.**
- **Freight firm.**
- **Average age up.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"If you make it to hell, heck at least make it comfy."

– Anonymous

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

Click "Ctrl" + below to launch the GMS Weekly Summary Podcast

WT…DECEMBER!

This year doesn't cease to surprise, as December just showed what true volatility can be — in a mere two consecutive weeks at that. What a week this has certainly been, where freight rates continue to fall, the U.S. Dollar forgets which way is up, oil rises yet remains low, local steel plate prices slip oddly across the board at the various destinations, all while Turkey enjoys a forced retirement from the sidelines, watching its currency values fall ever deeper into the abyss.

To start, inflation figures that were never released in the U.S. for October due to the government shutdown did come out for November. In Trump's "hottest country in the world," his regime reported inflation back down to 2.7% last month. India and Bangladesh were both up, but share the same reasons to celebrate, and Turkey was mercifully down as well. The Baltic Exchange Dry Index reported an overall drop of 2.3% this week, brought on by capes, panamax, and smaller vessels collectively dragging the Baltic down by 1.4%, nearly 5%, and 36 basis points, respectively.

This could likely be brought on by the mixed signals out of the U.S. economic inflation figures, along with oil futures that barely rose 73 basis points and close the week out at a globally welcome low of USD 56.86/barrel. As freight rates continue to fall, a collection of market and private fixtures started to announce their arrivals across sub-continent beaches as famished recyclers await upcoming deliveries. And the U.S. Dollar? I'll let the rest of the report speak for itself.

Meanwhile, with Christmas just around the corner, we can reflect on what a disastrous yet pivotal year of upgrades and change across the Indian sub-continent ship recycling markets (and even the ship recycling industry writ large) it has been, with the Hong Kong Convention for safe and responsible recycling finally coming into force on June 26 this year. With this landmark set of initiatives and guidelines finally in force, it is encouraging to see most of the previously 100+ yards HKC-certified by various classification bodies in Alang, 22 yards now in Bangladesh, and only one in Gadani (the rest clearly have some catching up to do) fully operational to a set of globally approved standards.

And just like the previous year, we have seen even lower levels of supply this year, following a 2024 that saw decade-low levels of supply. Although the performance of freight markets across all sectors has been largely responsible for the ongoing starvation in the supply of tonnage, could recent declines indicate a positive change for the ship recycling industry come 2026? Perhaps the timing in the shortage of supply was apt, as HKC upgrades and adapting to the new rules and regulations — not only for recyclers, but even local authorities to come to grips with — certainly helped everyone.

For 2026, as the average age of a trading vessel climbs from 25 years to 30 years in some cases, and '90s-built bulkers, tankers (albeit in the shadow fleet), and containers aplenty are still trading — and due to be phased out to accommodate newbuilding vessels hitting the water next year — this should hopefully serve up a buffet for the industry. **Fingers crossed, Santa!**

BANGLADESH

WILD YEAR!

22 yards approved.

While some might see that Bangladesh has endured an positive overall year where ship recycling is concerned — given the progress toward HKC-certified recycling, with 22 domestic ship recycling yards now HKC-accredited by various international bodies and work continuing in the background on a couple more yards — and given that it has enjoyed more time atop the market rankings than its regional neighbors for a majority of the year, offering regionally opening tonnage that extra USD/ton in the bank for all parties involved, that's about where the parade of pride would likely end.

Price decline.

On the flip side? Literally everything has declined in Bangladesh in 2025. To start, after breaching the USD 600/ton mark back in January 2024, local offerings have now declined by almost USD 200/LDT down to the low USD 400s/LDT, and certainly lower now that a recent surge of tonnage has local bellies full for the time being. Tariffs, the taka, steel plate prices, and a dearth in the supply of tonnage has left this market frustrated and deprived of any regular flow of business sense amid exasperating yard upgrades and infrastructure work, thanks to unexpectedly firm freight trading rates across the board.

LNGs find home.

And this week was probably 2025's cherry for Bangladeshi recyclers, as not only did the U.S. Dollar gain 20 basis points — pulling the taka up to BDT 122.30 once again — but local steel plate prices truly stole the spotlight, plummeting a massive USD 12/ton in just five days and closing the week out at USD 485/ton. To remind you, they stood at just over USD 600/ton not 45 days ago, which makes this an instrumental decline behind the ongoing strength of local offerings. And amid the HKC celebrations, we lost track of the fact that Bangladesh has now gone from a market of about 35 ship recycling yards to only 22 (even though a few more are reportedly still in the plans).

Shopping Bonanza.

For the nation at large, it's been even worse: 30% tariffs from Trump; the interim government doing its best to redefine lethargy; a monsoon that betrayed local yard-upgrade operations; interim confusion around inward-delivery procedural formalities causing massive delays during August to October across the waterfront — all gift-wrapped in recently resurging political violence that even saw the untimely death of a local electoral candidate, with riots re-erupting at key locations across the nation and business closures once again seemingly imminent as the date of the upcoming elections draws nearer.

Overall, although we can recognize that a large number of LNGs — even for select HKC-only yards for green recycling — were concluded to select end buyers in Bangladesh this year and the nation has now started to feasibly compete with India on these specialist units, it is 2026 that remains pivotal for the nation overall as not only does a hopeful inflow of tonnage likely lie in wait, but the upcoming elections should hopefully jolt the nation's economy back into gear, just in time for the pre-monsoon shopping bonanza to take on a new meaning.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

TAKING THE PRIZE!

India has certainly taken the 2025 prize for having the most torrid year of declines experienced by a ship-recycling destination in recent memory, so drastic has the overall drop over the last quarter been. And it's not just prices — like Bangladesh, a smorgasbord of tail-spinning events colluded to drag Alang down across nearly all of 2025, and the fact that this market somehow managed to take in the most tonnage and/or HKC units of any ship recycling destination across 2025 while still retaining the title of epicenter of the recycling world across late Q3/early Q4 — and that too in the face of declining local offerings — is a stellar retelling of the convolutions of the ship recycling world.

Dipping below 400.

Levels have certainly dipped below USD 400/LDT for many competitive, and even green, units that have consequently found their way to competing markets in Bangladesh and even Pakistan at different points this year. Worse yet? As the previous leading vanguard market in terms of creating the path on HKC development work, it was certainly frustrating to not see Alang use that to its full potential at any point this year (despite the ongoing shortage of tonnage), or that it will likely ever use it to its full potential again — especially as Pakistani yards start stacking the competitive odds across the entirety of the Indian sub-continent as well.

Vanguard market.

Fundamentals, fundamentals — where do we even start? The Rupee has turned into the bootleg paint-huffing cousin that everyone somehow aware of, suffering several drops, recoveries, relapses, and recurrent recoveries since Q3 2025, and it took on a whole new energy spike this week as it jumped against the U.S. Dollar by 1.07%, regaining territory back into the INR 89s once again and closing the week out at INR 89.57. Local steel plate prices, especially, seemed to have forgotten what gravity is, reportedly firming a massive USD 10/ton across five days, nearly wiping out recent losses and bringing an added layer of optimism about the next few weeks.

Bootleg paint.

2026 Workout.

Moreover, some market/private deals seemed to mercifully slip into Alang's waterfront this week and should keep local recyclers distracted in the face of ongoing sufferance(s), with nearly 26K LT worth of deliveries to look forward to — including a couple of decent LDT tankers.

With a hopeful 202X (another in the series of declining years) coming up, and the outlook being backed by declining freight rates and ever-aging units facing imminent surveys, let's hope the industry gives the HKC world a true 2026 workout.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

ONLY WAY IS UP!

Encouraging.

And for Pakistan, standing on the precipice of 2026, that remains a fact. Not only is it fantastically encouraging to see the first ship recycling yard gain HKC certification last month, but with more reportedly set to join the ranks within Q1 2026 and 2026 hopefully finally shaping up to be a healthier year in terms of supply, Gadani has certainly lined itself up to put a serious dent in the global ship recycling post-HKC era, where redistribution of recyclable tonnage is concerned.

Unfortunately, given Pakistan's ongoing and serious HKC handicap and despite being placed 2nd on the market rankings (in terms of pricing), DASR approvals have done their utmost to ensure regular business remains a nightmare. With incoming tonnage being regularly subjected to delays, it is no surprise that the industry remains wary of a Pakistan redelivery.

Back to buying.

Case in point: despite being the only recycling destination in the Indian sub-continent that is not tide-reliant and has the least restrictive inward requirements, vessels in a post-HKC era seem to be regularly facing delivery delays, as evidenced by the currently idling mini-VL that has been sitting at anchorage for nearly 20 days now.

Domestic fundamentals too have notably done more to help than hurt Gadani of late, as local steel plate prices jumped by over USD 4/ton and closed the week out near USD 580/ton — an industry-leading margin at present. Moreover, the recently firming PKR — which found itself back down around PKR 280 (from PKR 283) — lost 13 basis points but still closed the week out at PKR 280.30.

Next approvals due.

Overall, as work continues locally and more yards are set to join the global HKC fray, and as long as fundamentals hold their ground, Gadani is certainly set to have a busy year ahead — especially for the HKC-certified crew.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

ENJOYING THE VIEW?

Russian Roulette.

Aliaga recyclers seem to have relegated themselves to a forced holiday, as prevailing government restrictions fine-tuned the madness of the ongoing shortage of tonnage and pushed this market further away from industry attention across all of 2025. And with little else to report beyond the lira's ongoing ballet as it lost another 27 basis points against the U.S. Dollar this week and closed it out at TRY 42.81, edging ever closer to an imminent breach of TRY 43.

Inflation last month, however, took a notable drop, falling nearly 2% down to TRY 31% (from 32.87% in October) and marking its lowest reading since November 2021. As domestic prices for virtually everything pivot south for the winter, this should also help Aliaga recyclers manage their operational margins a little better — especially in the face of an ever-declining Lira.

With 2026 showing signs of promise, let's hope Turkey's current pricing trajectory holds long enough for local recyclers to step back into the game once again.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 51 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

OH REALITY!!

- *After Michael Jackson died in 2009, Sony released a posthumous album called Michael in 2010. Almost immediately, fans began to question whether all the vocals on the album were actually Jackson's. Three songs — "Breaking News," "Keep Your Head Up," and "Monster" — were accused of featuring an impersonator instead of Jackson. Sony stated the songs came from recordings Jackson made in 2007 at the New Jersey home of his friend and producer Eddie Cascio (who also claimed it was Jackson on the tracks). But many fans, experts, and even some of Jackson's family members insisted the voice didn't sound like him. A lawsuit was filed against Sony and the producers in 2014, claiming they knowingly released fake songs to cash in on Jackson's legacy. For years, Sony denied wrongdoing, though in 2022, the three disputed songs were quietly removed from streaming services, further fueling suspicions that the recordings were not authentic.*
- *During World War II, Boeing built a large fake neighborhood on top of its factory in Seattle to hide it from possible Japanese air attacks. Following the attack on Pearl Harbor, Japanese submarines were spotted off the coasts of San Francisco and Santa Barbara, so Boeing decided it would be necessary to disguise its Plant 2 in Seattle. At the time, Plant 2 was producing B-17 bombers, making it a major military target. To hide the site, engineers, with the help of Hollywood set designers, constructed an elaborate camouflage system above the plant that looked like a suburban neighborhood from above. The fake town (which had smaller-scale buildings) included painted streets, houses made of plywood and chicken wire, and even fake trees and cars. Employees would also walk around the neighborhoods or do "chores" up there to further give the illusion that it was inhabited. From the air, the massive factory below looked like a quiet residential area. The illusion was so convincing that pilots flying overhead often had no idea a huge aircraft plant was beneath them*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 24 – Christmas Eve December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – New Year's Eve	December 18 – December 25 January 01 – January 08 January 17 – January 24

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – Bank Holiday	December 03 – December 06 December 21 – December 24

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
December 25 – Quaid-e-Azam	**No holidays in December**

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of December 19, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Asena*	*3,196*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered December 18*
2	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
3	Mackerel	8,868	Oil Tanker	Arrived December 17
4	*Morality*	*9,852*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered December 11*
5	*Prestige*	*3,307*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered December 19*
Morality		**45,224**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of December 19, 2025

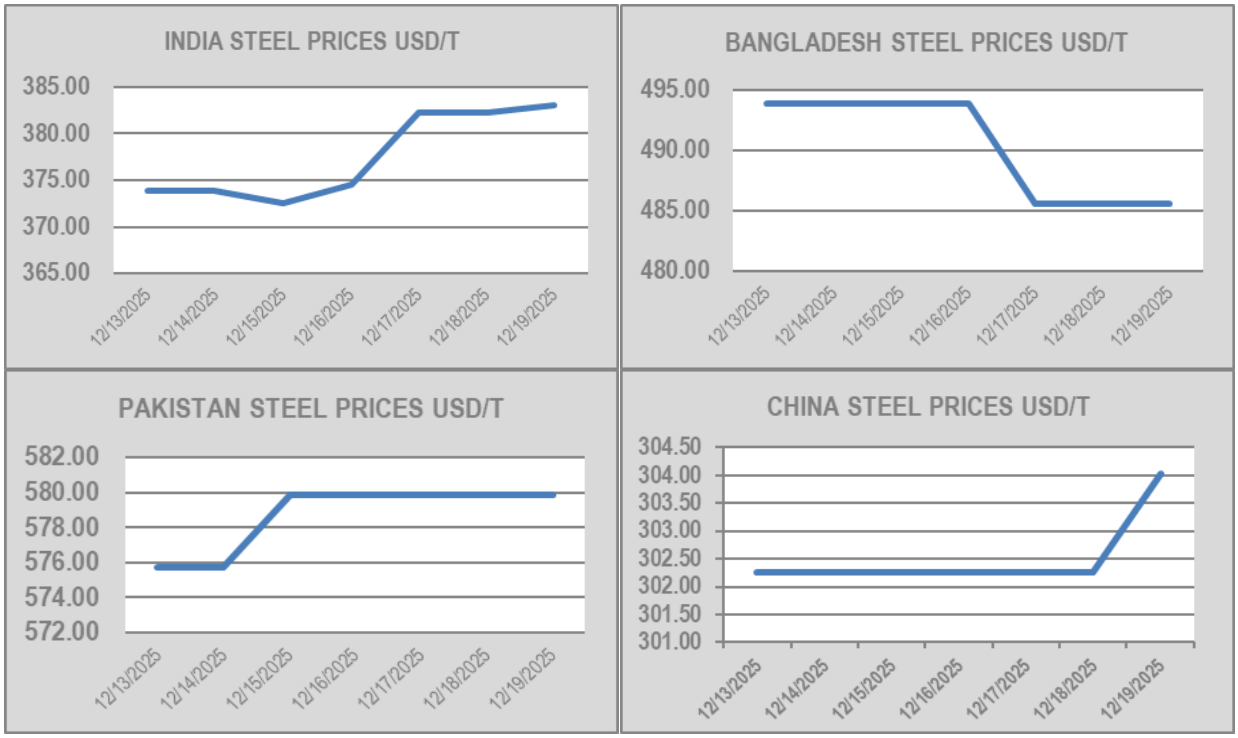
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Bold Marines	7,507	Bulk Carrier	Arrived December 14
2	Elite Prosperity (Under Tow)	13,733	Barge	Arrived December 19
3	Fan Shun	7,690	Bulk Carrier	Arrived December 12
4	Zi Yu Lan	7,542	MPP	Arrived December 19
		36,472		

GADANI - Port Position as of December 19, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ardhianto	2,922	General Cargo	Arrived December 04
Total Tonnage		**2,922**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
12/13/2025	373.81	33,800.00	575.69	162,000.00	493.83	60,000.00	302.25
12/14/2025	373.81	33,800.00	575.69	162,000.00	493.83	60,000.00	302.25
12/15/2025	372.53	33,800.00	579.86	163,000.00	493.83	60,000.00	302.25
12/16/2025	374.60	34,100.00	579.86	163,000.00	493.83	60,000.00	302.25
12/17/2025	382.31	34,500.00	579.86	163,000.00	485.60	59,000.00	302.25
12/18/2025	382.31	34,500.00	579.86	163,000.00	485.60	59,000.00	302.25
12/19/2025	383.12	34,500.00	579.86	163,000.00	485.60	59,000.00	304.04



ANDROID APP ON Google play
Download on the App Store

www.gmsinc.net
GMS_Leadership
GMS Leadership
snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311